

Project Expense Monitoring: System Manual and Process Flow

Version 1.0, first release for live use · Prepared Sep 28, 2026

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1. About this manual

This manual explains how a project expense moves through the Project Expense Monitoring system, from a liaison's request to a closed record, and who does what at each step. It describes the system as released for live use.

- **Purpose:** a single reference for how the system works, for training.
- **Scope:** requests for project other expenses (bidding, collection, support, inspection and testing), their approval against each project's allocation, disbursement, payment to the client, fund returns, verification, reclassification and reporting.
- **Audience:** liaisons, top management, accounting, administrators.
- **Out of scope:** Acumatica procedures (the cash advance itself is filed in Acumatica; this system only records its reference number) and Supabase hosting (see the separate SETUP guide).

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2. System overview and key terms

The system controls every project other expense against the allocation set for that project and expense type. A liaison files a request, top management approves it against the remaining balance, accounting disburses the fund, the liaison gives it to the client, and the line is verified and closed. Every step is recorded with who did it and when.

Term	Meaning
Project	A DPWH project, identified by its project ID (for example 26HO0114), with its district, year, contract value and status.
Internal project	ADVANCES and FOR-ASSIGNMENT: funds released before the project is known. They have no allocation and are later reclassified to specific projects.
Expense category	One of five groups: Bidding, Collection, Support, Inspection, Testing.
Expense type	The specific expense within a category, such as Buy-out, DE Share, DOLE, QAU or MQC. Each has its own allocation per project.
Allocation	The limit for one expense type on one project: a percentage of the contract value, a default fixed amount, or an amount set for that project.
Request	One filing by a liaison, numbered REQ-YYYY-NNNN (for example REQ-2026-0012). It holds one or more lines.
Line	One expense within a request: project, expense type, amount, payee, remarks and supporting documents. Approval, payment and returns are tracked per line.
ERP reference	The Acumatica cash advance number (for example CA0000000000639) entered after approval.
Approved to date	Approved lines that are open, disbursed, partly paid, paid or closed, net of any returned money.

Term	Meaning
In approval	Lines waiting for top management.
Balance	Allocation minus approved to date.
Near limit	Approved to date has reached the near-limit level (90% by default, set in Settings).

3. Roles and access rights

Every user has one of five roles, and each role has a set of access rights. The table shows the defaults at go-live. An administrator can change them in Settings, Access rights, except where noted.

Access right	Administrator	Top management	Accounting	Liaison
Project report	✓	✓	✓	
See limits and balances while filing	✓	✓	✓	
View project listing	✓	✓	✓	
Add and edit projects	✓	✓		
Set project allocations	✓	✓		
File new requests	✓			✓
Request list: own requests only				✓
Request list: all requests	✓	✓	✓	
Approve or reject requests	✓	✓		
Enter ERP reference	✓			✓
Mark fund as disbursed	✓		✓	
Mark lines as paid to client	✓			✓
Verify paid lines as accounting	✓		✓	
Verify paid lines as top management	✓	✓		
Reclassify lines from internal projects	✓	✓	✓	
Record fund returns	✓	✓	✓	Not allowed
Analysis	✓	✓	✓	
Expense categories, types and rates	✓	✓		
Users, access rights and system settings	✓	✓		

Rules that apply regardless of the settings:

- **Administrators** always have every right. This is for data fixing access.
- **Fund returns** are limited to administrators, top management and accounting. The checkbox is locked for other roles, and the database checks the role as well.

- **Own requests:** nobody else may approve, or record a return on, a request they filed, except an administrator.
- **Liaisons** see only their own requests and never another liaison's requests, documents or history.
- **Sign-in** is by username and password. Accounts are created by an administrator; a deactivated user can no longer sign in.

4. End-to-end process flow

A request passes six steps from filing to closed; three branches can leave the main path. The main path is on the left; the shaded boxes are the branches.

Six steps from request to closed, with three branches

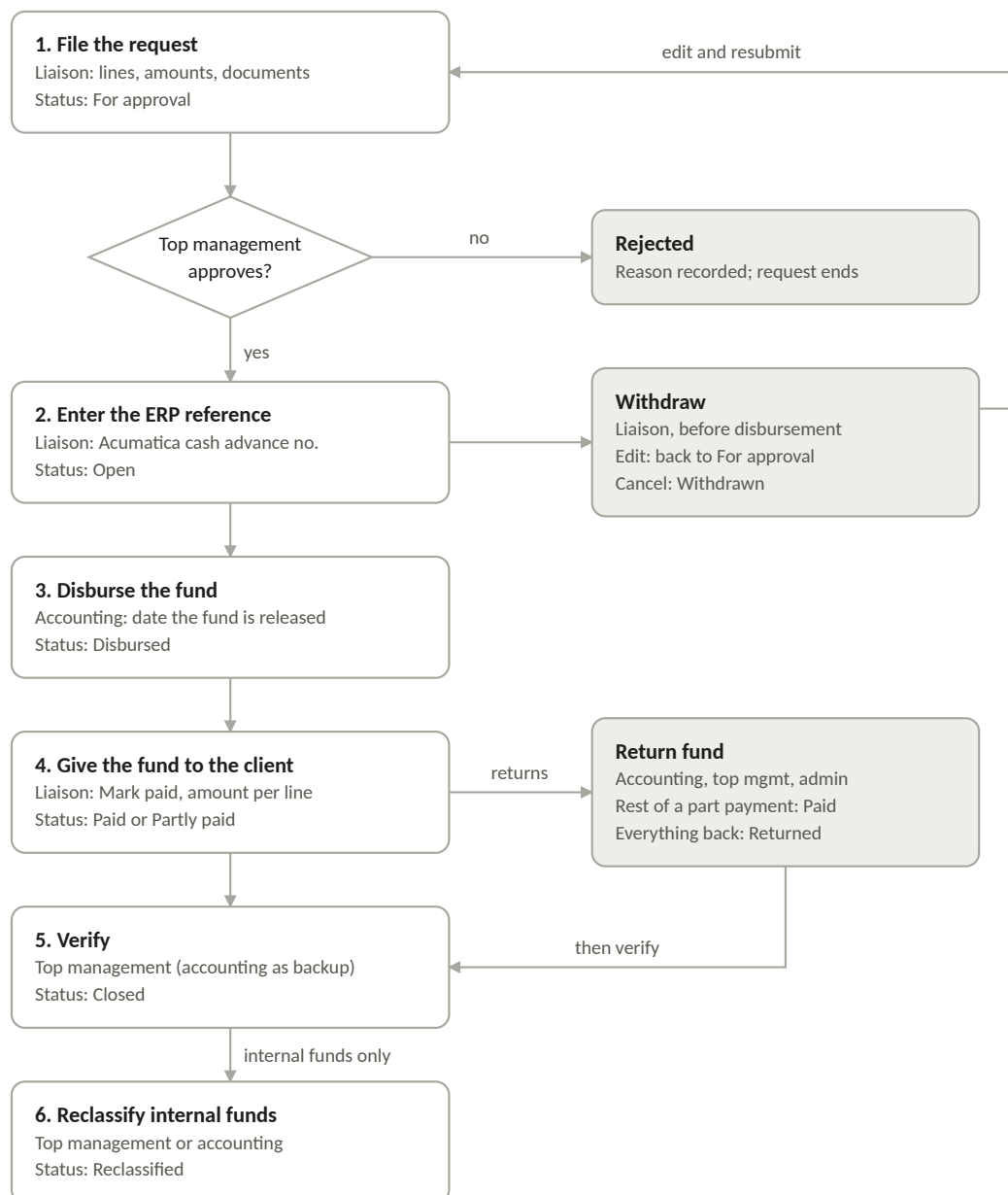


Figure 1. Process flow: six steps on the main path, three branches

Approval, withdrawal and verification act on the whole request. Payment to the client, fund returns and reclassification act on individual lines, so one request can have lines at different stages. The procedures in sections 6 to 11 follow these steps in order.

5. Request and line statuses

A request's status says where the whole request stands; each line also has its own status, because payment and returns are recorded per line.

Request status	Meaning	Next action (who)
For approval	Filed; waiting for top management	Approve or reject (top management). The liaison may edit or cancel.
Open	Approved; fund not yet released	Enter the ERP reference (liaison), then disburse (accounting). The liaison may still edit, which sends it back for approval, or cancel.
Disbursed	Fund released to the liaison	Mark lines paid (liaison); record any returns (accounting).
Partially paid	Some lines, or part of a line, given to the client	Pay the remaining lines (liaison); record the return of any unpaid rest (accounting).
Paid	Every remaining line fully accounted for	Verify (top management; accounting as backup).
Closed	Verified	None, unless it has lines under an internal project to reclassify.
Reclassified	Closed; internal-project amounts split to specific projects	None.
Rejected	Not approved by top management	None. The reason is in the history.
Withdrawn	Cancelled by the liaison before disbursement	Void the Acumatica cash advance if an ERP reference was entered.
Returned	Every disbursed line came back in full	None.

A line ends Closed, Returned or not approved

Line statuses and what moves a line from one to the next

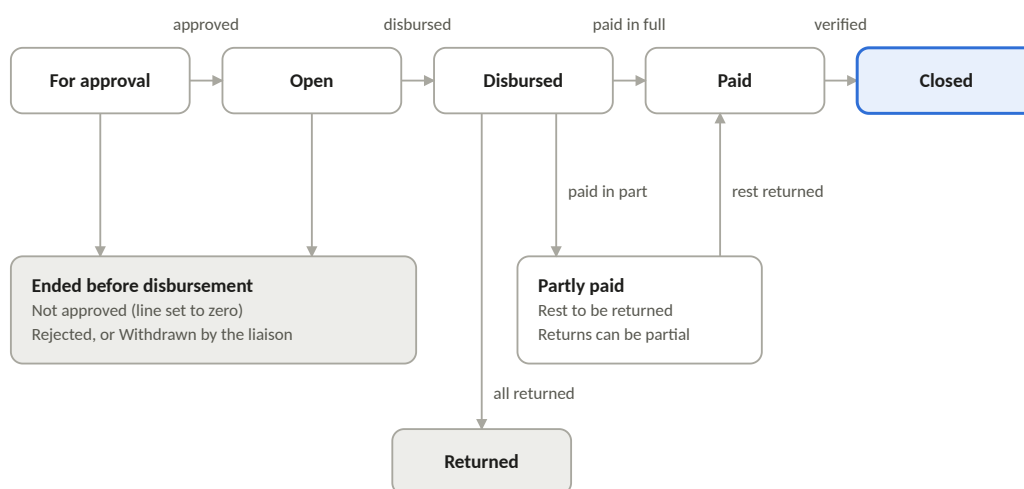


Figure 2. Line statuses: five on the main path, three endings

A partial return on a Disbursed line keeps it Disbursed until the rest is paid or returned. A Partly paid line cannot be verified until the rest is returned.

Days in status. The request list shows how many days a request has been in its current status, under its status chip and in the CSV export. The count restarts when the status changes and is not shown once a request is Closed, Rejected, Withdrawn or Returned.

6. Procedure: filing a request

The liaison files one request for one or more expenses; the reference number is issued on submission and the request goes to top management as For approval.

Who: Liaison (or an administrator). **Where:** New request.

1. Fill in the request details at the top:
 - **Request date** (today by default).
 - **Date needed**, required, and not earlier than the request date.
 - **Description** of the request, required.
2. Add a line for each expense (**Add line**; the copy icon duplicates a line):
 - **Project ID**: type or pick the project. Use ADVANCES or FOR-ASSIGNMENT when the project is not yet known.
 - **Category** and **Expense type**.
 - **Amount** and **Payee or recipient**.
 - **Remarks**, optional.
 - Any extra field the type asks for, such as **Type of insurance** or, for Others, what it is for.
3. For calculated lines, check the figure the system works out:
 - **Bidding (Buy-out, Pre & Post Bidding, Planning)**: the amount is the project's contract value times the type's rate. It may be lowered but not raised above the calculated amount; **Use calculated** restores it.
 - **Collection (DE Share, Construction Share)**: enter the billing percent (for reference) and the net collection. The amount is the net collection times the type's rate.
4. Attach supporting documents with the paperclip on each line: PDF, JPG, PNG or WebP, up to 10 MB each. Lines in a category that requires a document (Collection by default) cannot be submitted without one; any other line may carry optional files.
5. Select **Submit request** and confirm. The system shows the reference number, for example REQ-2026-0012.

Checks at submission. Every line needs a project, category, expense type, an amount above zero and a payee, plus any extra field its type asks for. The system also checks each line against its allocation:

- **Balance** = allocation – approved to date – other requests still in approval – this request.
- Users who can see limits get a warning when a line is near or over its limit.
- Liaisons do not see limits. Top management sees the same check when approving.

After filing. While the request is For approval, the liaison can still attach more documents to any line, or remove files they attached (a required line keeps at least one). Leaving the page with unsaved lines asks for confirmation.

7. Procedure: editing, withdrawing or cancelling a request

A request can be edited or cancelled until its fund is disbursed; after that it is locked. Editing an approved request sends it back to top management.

Who: the liaison who filed it, or an administrator. **When:** status For approval, or Open (approved, not yet disbursed). **Where:** Request list → open the request → **Withdraw**.

1. Select **Withdraw**. A window offers three choices: **Edit request**, **Cancel request** or **Keep as is**.
2. **To edit**, choose Edit request. The request opens in the New request form with everything filled in, under the same reference number.
 - Change amounts, lines, dates, the description or documents; add or remove lines.
 - Where top management had approved a different amount, the line shows "Previously approved" with that amount.
 - Select **Save changes** and confirm.
3. **To cancel**, choose Cancel request, enter a reason if wanted, and confirm. The request moves to Withdrawn.

Status when edited	What happens on Save changes
For approval	Stays in the approval queue with the same reference number.
Open	Goes back to For approval. The earlier approval and any ERP reference are cleared; after re-approval the liaison enters the ERP reference again.

- **History:** each edit is logged with the change in totals, for example "Edited: total 78,000.00 → 75,500.00". A cancellation is logged with its reason.
- **ERP reference:** if one had been entered, the cancellation note reminds accounting to void that cash advance in Acumatica.
- **Conflicts:** the save is refused if top management approved or rejected the request, or accounting disbursed it, while it was being edited.

8. Procedure: approval by top management

Top management approves each request line by line against the project's allocation, and may lower an amount or decline a line; a rejection needs a reason.

Who: Top management (or an administrator). **Where:** Approvals. The number beside Approvals in the menu is the count waiting.

1. Open **Approvals**. Requests are listed oldest first; select one to see its lines, supporting documents and the liaison's description.
2. Check each line against its allocation:
 - Each line shows the limit, approved to date, other requests in approval, this request and the balance, marked Within limit, Near limit or Exceeds limit.
 - Select a line's project ID to open that project's report, with this line highlighted.
 - Select a document to view it in the app.

3. Adjust the **approved amount** of any line if needed:
 - It can be lowered but not raised above what was requested.
 - Set it to zero to decline that line (it shows as Not approved).
 - At least one line must stay above zero.
4. Add **approval remarks** if needed (optional; kept with the request).
5. Select **Approve**. If a line goes past its allocation, the system asks to confirm with **Approve anyway**. The request moves to Open.
6. To refuse the whole request, select **Reject** and enter the reason (required). The liaison sees it on the request, and the request moves to Rejected.

Rules

- Approvers cannot approve their own requests, except administrators.
- A liaison can still attach documents, edit or cancel while a request waits here. If they edit it, top management sees the updated version.

9. Procedure: ERP reference and disbursement

After approval the liaison files the cash advance in Acumatica and records its number here; accounting then releases the fund and marks the request Disbursed.

Step A: enter the ERP reference. Who: the liaison who filed the request (or an administrator).

1. File the cash advance in Acumatica for the approved amounts.
2. In the Request list, open the request. Under **ERP reference and disbursement**, type the Acumatica reference number (for example CA0000000000639).
3. Select **Save ERP reference**. Until disbursement, **Change** allows correcting it.

Step B: disburse. Who: Accounting (or an administrator).

1. Open the request; it shows the ERP reference and who entered it.
2. Enter the **disbursement date** and, optionally, **accounting remarks** such as the check or voucher number.
3. Select **Mark as disbursed**. The request and its approved lines move to Disbursed.

Rules

- Accounting can disburse only after the ERP reference is entered.
- Once disbursed, the request can no longer be edited or withdrawn; money coming back is handled as a fund return (section 10).
- The Analysis tab "Request to disbursement" measures how long this stage takes.

10. Procedure: giving the fund to the client and fund returns

Every disbursed line tracks three amounts: what was **paid to the client**, what was **returned**, and what is **still with the liaison**. Only returned money is removed from the project report.

Step A: mark as paid. Who: the liaison who filed the request.

1. Open the request and tick the Disbursed lines that were given to the client.
2. Select **Mark paid....** A window lists each line with its amount prefilled to everything still with the liaison.
3. Keep the amount if the whole amount was given; lower it if less was given. The window shows how much a lowered line leaves to be returned to accounting.
4. Enter the **date given to client** (not in the future, not before disbursement) and optional remarks, then confirm.

A line given in full becomes **Paid**. A line given in part becomes **Partly paid**, and its rest can only be settled by accounting recording its return. A line is marked paid once.

Step B: record a fund return. Who: Accounting, top management or an administrator. **When:** the line is Disbursed or Partly paid, including on a Partially paid request.

1. Open the request and select **Return fund** on the line. Partly paid lines appear in accounting's Needs my action as "Record the return of ₪...".
2. The window shows the line's money: disbursed, paid to client, returned so far, and with the liaison. The **amount returned** is prefilled with everything still with the liaison (a full return); lower it for a partial return.
3. Enter the **date returned** (not in the future, not before disbursement), the **receipt or reference number** (official or acknowledgement receipt, or the Acumatica entry) and the **reason**.
4. Select **Record return** and confirm. Several partial returns on one line are allowed; each is listed on the line with who recorded it.

Result of a return

Line before	Return	Line after
Disbursed, nothing paid	Part of the amount	Disbursed; the rest is still with the liaison
Disbursed, nothing paid	Everything	Returned; if every line came back, the request is Returned
Partly paid	Part of the rest	Partly paid
Partly paid	All of the rest	Paid, ready for verification

Worked example

A Planning line is approved and disbursed at ₪482,000. The liaison gives ₪400,000 to the client and marks it paid; the line becomes Partly paid with ₪82,000 still with the liaison. Accounting records ₪50,000 returned (OR-5001), then ₪32,000 (OR-5002); the line becomes Paid. The project report counts ₪482,000 until the returns are recorded, then ₪400,000.

Rules

- A return is final; there is no undo.
- Paid and closed lines cannot be returned.
- The person who filed the request cannot record its return, except an administrator.
- On a line under ADVANCES or FOR-ASSIGNMENT, a return cannot cut into money already reclassified to projects.

11. Procedure: verification, closing and reclassification

A paid line closes once it is verified. Lines filed under ADVANCES or FOR-ASSIGNMENT are then split to the projects they actually belong to.

Step A: verify paid lines. Who: Top management; accounting as backup.

1. Open the request (Needs my action lists requests with lines to verify) and tick the Paid lines.
2. Select **Verify as top management**, or **Verify as accounting (backup)**.
3. A verified line becomes Closed. When every remaining line is closed, the request becomes Closed.

The verification rule is set in Settings, System:

Setting	Line closes when
One verification (default)	Top management verifies, or accounting verifies as backup
Both must verify	Both accounting and top management have verified

Partly paid, returned and not-approved lines are never verified; a Partly paid line must first have its rest returned (section 10).

Step B: reclassify internal-project lines. Who: Top management, accounting or an administrator. **When:** the line is under ADVANCES or FOR-ASSIGNMENT and its fund has been disbursed.

1. Open the request and select **Reclassify** on the line (**Edit split** if it was already split).
2. Add a row for each project the money belongs to, with its amount and optional remarks.
 - Each project can appear once, and only specific (not internal) projects can be used.
 - The total cannot exceed the line amount after returns.
 - Anything not split stays on the internal project.
3. Save. Saving again replaces the earlier split; removing every row undoes it.

Effect of a split

- The Project report, Excel export, filters and Analysis count each part on its project and take it off the internal project.
- The original line stays unchanged, and each split is logged in the history.
- A closed request with a split shows as Reclassified.
- Until the whole amount is assigned, the request shows "For reclassification" or "Partially reclassified (P... remaining)".

12. Monitoring and reports

The Project report shows each project's allocation against approved and pending requests; the Request list tracks every request's stage; Analysis measures turnaround times and spending.

Screen	Who (default)	What it shows	Actions
Project report	Administrator, top management, accounting, auditor	Five totals: allocation, approved to date, in approval, balance, projects over a limit. Per project, approved against allocation for each category (or each type within a category), with bars that turn amber near the limit and red when over.	Search; filter by year, district, status, projects with requests or over a limit; sort; open a project; Export to Excel
Project drawer	Same	Expense breakdown per type, project details and allocations	Set allocations (administrator, top management)
Request list	Everyone; liaisons see only their own	Status cards (Needs my action, For approval, Open, Disbursed, Partially paid, Paid, Closed, Reclassified, Returned, Rejected / withdrawn) with counts and totals; days in status	Filter by card, requester and search; open a request; print its form; export CSV
Approvals	Top management, administrator	Requests waiting for approval, oldest first	Approve, adjust, reject (section 8)
Analysis	Administrator, top management, accounting	Turnaround times and spending (below)	Filters; CSV exports
Project listing	Administrator, top management, accounting, auditor	All projects with contract and status details	Add and edit projects (administrator)

Needs my action. The first card on the Request list counts the requests waiting on the signed-in user:

- **Liaison:** enter an ERP reference, or give a fund to the client.
- **Top management:** approve, or verify.
- **Accounting:** disburse, record a return, or verify as backup.

Export to Excel (Project report). The workbook follows the filters set on the page and has three sheets:

1. **Records:** every request line on the reported projects. It shows requested, approved, paid to client and returned amounts, the status, and "Counts as" (Approved to date, In approval or Not counted) with the amount counted. Returns and reclassifications are noted.
2. **Summary:** the report as on screen. The five totals sit at the top; per project, each category shows approved to date, in approval, allocation and share used, then the totals and limits exceeded. Amber marks the near-limit level; red marks over.
3. **By expense type:** the same comparison for each expense type on each project, with a limit status and filters.

The Summary and By expense type figures are formulas that add up the Records sheet, so every amount can be traced to its lines.

Analysis tabs

- **Request to disbursement:** days from filing to disbursement, split into approval (top management), ERP reference (liaison) and disbursement (accounting); averages, medians and waiting requests by stage.
- **Disbursed to paid:** days from disbursement to the fund reaching the client, against a target (3 days by default, adjustable on the tab); results by liaison and a list of funds not yet given.
- **Expenses:** spending by category and month, expense types ranked by share (the types making up 80% are highlighted), with a drill-down by project and a choice of amount basis (approved to date, released, or including those in approval).

13. Administration

Administrators maintain users, access rights, the expense setup and system settings from Settings; every change applies at once to all users.

Settings tab	Used for
Expense categories and types	Add or rename categories and expense types; set each type's calculation (entered amount, % of contract value, or % of net collection), rate, default fixed amount, Acumatica account and any extra field; switch Require a supporting document per category (Collection by default).
SOP rates per district	A district rate for an expense type, overriding the type's default rate for every project in that district. A blank cell uses the default.
Users	Invite users by email (they set their own password); set each user's role; rename; Remove access or Grant access . Administrators cannot change their own role.
Access rights	Tick or untick each access right per role (section 3).
System	Settings listed below.

System setting	Default	Effect
Reference prefix	REQ	New request numbers, for example REQ-2026-0001. Existing numbers never change.
Verification	One verification	Top management verifies and accounting is the backup, or both must verify (section 11).
Near-limit warning at	90%	Share of an allocation at which lines and bars show a warning.
Sign out after inactivity	30 minutes	Signs an idle user out; 0 turns it off.
Printed form title	Special Request Payment Form	Heading of the printed request form.

Projects and allocations. Administrators add and edit projects in Project listing. Allocations for a project are set in its drawer, on the Allocations tab (administrators and top management). A set amount replaces the default calculated from the contract value.

Go-live and upgrades. The database is installed or upgraded by running `supabase_schema.sql` in the Supabase SQL Editor, as described in the SETUP guide. Rerunning it keeps existing requests and settings.

14. Controls and safeguards

The rules below are enforced by the database itself, not only by the screens, so they hold even if someone bypasses the app.

Control	Risk it addresses	How it works
Approval before release	Funds released without authority	A request cannot be disbursed until top management approves it and its ERP reference is entered.
Allocation check	Spending past the budget	Each line is checked against allocation – approved to date – other pending requests; going over needs an explicit Approve anyway.
Separation of duties	One person controlling a whole transaction	The liaison files, pays and enters the ERP reference; top management approves; accounting disburses; verification closes. Nobody approves, or records a return on, a request they filed, except an administrator.
Complete filings	Unsupported or incomplete requests	Required fields, date rules and required documents are checked on submission.
Re-approval after changes	Approved amounts changed afterwards	Editing an approved request sends it back for approval and clears its ERP reference. After disbursement, the request is locked.
Amount integrity	Double payment or overstated returns	One payment per line; payments and returns cannot exceed what is with the liaison; paid plus returned can never exceed the approved amount; dates cannot be in the future or before disbursement.
Controlled returns	Hiding a disbursement by marking it returned	Only accounting, top management or an administrator can record a return, with a receipt number and reason. It is final and logged.
Reclassification limits	Money assigned twice	A split cannot exceed the line amount after returns, and a return cannot cut into money already split.
Audit trail	Untraceable changes	Every action is logged with who and when: filing, edits, approval, ERP reference, disbursement, payments, returns, verification, splits and documents.
Access and privacy	Unauthorised viewing	Liaisons see only their own requests. Documents are stored privately and open through links valid for 10 minutes. Visitors who are not signed in can read nothing, and the sign-in page shows no company or system name.
No side doors	Edits outside the workflow	Direct edits to request records through the database API are refused; every change goes through the checked workflow.
Idle sign-out	Unattended sessions	Users are signed out after the set inactivity period (30 minutes by default).
Traceable reports	Figures that cannot be checked	The Excel summary is built from formulas over the Records sheet.

15. Quick reference and glossary

Task	Who	Where	Section
File a request	Liaison	New request	6
Attach more documents while For approval	Liaison	Request → paperclip on the line	6
Edit or cancel before disbursement	Liaison	Request → Withdraw	7
Approve, adjust or reject	Top management	Approvals	8
Enter the ERP reference	Liaison	Request → ERP reference and disbursement	9
Disburse the fund	Accounting	Request → ERP reference and disbursement	9
Mark lines paid (full or part)	Liaison	Request → tick lines → Mark paid...	10
Record a fund return (full or partial)	Accounting, top management, administrator	Request → Return fund on the line	10
Verify paid lines	Top management; accounting as backup	Request → tick lines → Verify	11
Split an ADVANCES or FOR-ASSIGNMENT line	Top management, accounting	Request → Reclassify on the line	11
Check allocations and balances	Management, accounting, auditor	Project report	12
Export the report to Excel	Same	Project report → Export to Excel	12
Manage users, access and settings	Administrator	Settings	13

Term	Meaning
Partly paid	A line where the liaison gave the client less than was disbursed; the rest must be returned to accounting.
Partially paid	A request where some lines, or part of a line, have been given to the client and others not yet.
With the liaison	Money disbursed but not yet given to the client or returned.
Not approved	A line top management set to zero while approving the rest of the request.
Returned	A line, or a whole request, whose fund came back in full; it no longer counts in the report.
Reclassified	A closed request whose ADVANCES or FOR-ASSIGNMENT amount has been split to specific projects.
Approve anyway	The confirmation top management gives to approve a line past its allocation.
Needs my action	The Request list card counting requests waiting on the signed-in user.
Days in status	Days since a request entered its current status.